

Arqivea Design System

1. Design standard

1.1 System goals

- Provide a unified visual and interactive language for Discovery, Route Planner, and Footprint across multiple museums.
- Balance an academic / archival feel with moments of playful, narrative energy in Footprint and sharing flows.
- Use a small, consistent set of colors and components that scale from low-fidelity prototypes to production UI in Next.js.
- Meet WCAG 2.1 Level AA color contrast requirements: at least 4.5:1 for body text and 3:1 for large text and UI elements.

1.2 Design principles

1. Calm canvas, vivid stories
 - Keep the overall UI quiet and neutral (soft whites and greys) and let artwork details, footprints, and share cards carry the visual drama.
2. Information first, narrative second
 - Prioritize clear information structure (search, filters, lists, route details, maps) and layer narratives and anecdotes in clearly defined secondary areas.
3. List + overlay to keep the flow
 - Favor list + overlay/modal patterns over hard page transitions so users can explore artworks, details, and routes without losing context.
4. Routes as collections, footprints as memories
 - Route flows emphasize clarity and efficiency; Footprint and sharing flows emphasize personal memory, travel, and achievement with warmer visual accents.

1.3 Accessibility standard

- For body text, ensure foreground vs background contrast ratio $\geq 4.5:1$ (WCAG AA).
- For large text (≥ 18 px regular or ≥ 14 px bold) and essential UI icons / shapes, ensure contrast ratio $\geq 3:1$.

- Do not rely on color alone to convey meaning (e.g., success vs error); always pair color with iconography and/or text.

2. Design tokens

This system is **semantic-first**: components reference semantic tokens such as `color-text-primary` and `color-bg-page` instead of raw hex values.

2.1 Color tokens

2.1.1 Background & surface

Token name	Description	HEX
color-bg-page	Global page background	#F4F4F2
color-surface-default	Default card / panel background	#E8E8E8
color-surface-soft-warm	Soft warm background (stories, hints, empty states)	#F6F7D3
color-surface-soft-cool	Soft cool background / Footprint main background	#CAE4DB

2.1.2 Text

Token name	Description	HEX
color-text-primary	Primary body text / main headings	#333333
color-text-secondary	Secondary text / meta information	#495464
color-text-strong	Emphasis, links, key numerical values	#333C4A
color-text-inverse	Text on dark surfaces (buttons, banners)	#F4F4F2
color-text-muted	Disabled text, placeholders, weak dividers	#BBBFCA

Guidance:

- Use `text-primary` for most body copy and key headings.
- Use `text-secondary` for metadata (dates, “3 stops” , durations) and helper text.
- Use `text-strong` for emphasis and interactive text (links), preferably with additional affordances (underline, hover).
- Use `text-muted` only for **non-essential** information (low contrast by design, not suitable for core content).

2.1.3 Actions & functional colors

Token name	Description	HEX
color-action-primary	Primary actions (CTAs, primary links)	#495464
color-action-primary-text	Text on primary actions	#F4F4F2
color-action-primary-hover (suggested)	Hover state for primary actions	#495464 with adjusted lightness (±5–10%)

2.1.4 Emotive colors

Emotive colors are shared across Discovery, Route Planner, and Footprint, but used with different densities. Discovery and Route Planner keep a predominantly neutral, functional look; Footprint concentrates accent colors on completed routes and share artifacts, not on structural chrome.

Token name	Description	HEX
color-footprint-bg	Footmap background / footprint cards	#CAE4DB
color-footprint-highlight	Route lines, map markers, key labels	#00303F
color-share-highlight	Sharing accents (badges, share chips, card strips)	#CDAC81

Usage across features:

- Discovery
 - Keep the page and cards neutral (`color-bg-page` , `color-surface-default`).
 - Use accent colors only for small, local elements:
 - Artwork detail overlay: a thin top border or divider in `color-surface-soft-warm` or `color-share-highlight` .
 - Filter / tag selected states: background in `color-surface-soft-warm` or `color-footprint-bg` , text in `color-text-strong` .
 - Never tint large page sections with accent colors — artworks themselves provide the main visual color.
- Route Planner
 - Use neutrals for the overall layout; introduce accents in route-specific UI:
 - Summary bar for the current route: optional soft background using `color-surface-soft-warm` to indicate “this is an active plan” .
 - Time & distance pills between museums: background `color-footprint-bg` to visually connect planning with footprints.

- Route status labels: `Planning` uses neutral greys; `Completed` uses `color-share-highlight` as background with `color-text-strong` text.
 - Footprint
 - Keep the page background neutral (`color-bg-page`) to stay consistent with other sections.
 - Use `color-footprint-bg` primarily for the world map / footprint map container and specific footprint cards, with `color-footprint-highlight` for route lines and markers.
 - Left-hand route list remains neutral (`color-surface-default` + greys), using `color-share-highlight` only on completion / “Shared” badges.
 - The visual share card is where accent colors can be richest (combining illustration, `color-share-highlight`, and `color-footprint-bg`), while the surrounding modal chrome stays neutral.
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2.2 Spacing, radius, elevation (v1)

You can start with a minimal but consistent token set and expand later.

2.2.1 Spacing

- `space-4 = 4px`
- `space-8 = 8px`
- `space-12 = 12px`
- `space-16 = 16px`
- `space-24 = 24px`
- `space-32 = 32px`

Typical usage:

- Inner padding of components: 8 / 12 / 16.
- Gaps between components in a section: 16 / 24.
- Vertical rhythm between page sections: 24 / 32.

2.2.2 Radius

- `radius-sm = 4px` (tags, small buttons)
- `radius-md = 8px` (cards, medium containers)
- `radius-lg = 16px` (large containers, modals)

2.2.3 Elevation / shadows

- `shadow-none` – flat surfaces, basic cards.
- `shadow-soft` – subtle elevation for hover states and tooltips.
- `shadow-strong` – modals and high-priority overlays.

2.3 Typography tokens

2.3.1 Font families

- `font-family-base`:
`system-ui, -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", sans-serif`
- `font-family-display` (optional):
Reserved for brand marks / logotype / occasional large titles once the brand typeface is defined.

2.3.1 Primitive typography tokens

Font weights

- `font-weight-regular = 400`
- `font-weight-medium = 500`
- `font-weight-semibold = 600`

Font sizes (example set; adjust per actual visual tests)

- `font-size-12, 14, 16, 20, 24, 32`

Line heights

- `line-height-tight = 1.2`
- `line-height-normal = 1.4`
- `line-height-relaxed = 1.6`

2.3.1 Semantic text styles

Token name	Usage	Spec (example)
type-heading-xl	Page titles (“Route Planner” , “Archive”)	base family, 32px, lh 1.2, weight semibold, text-primary
type-heading-l	Section titles (“Your routes: 2”)	24px, lh 1.3, weight semibold, text-primary
type-heading-m	Card titles (route names, artwork titles)	18–20px, lh 1.3, weight medium, text-primary
type-body	Body copy (academic notes, stories)	16px, lh 1.6, weight regular, text-primary
type-body-small	Secondary body / helper text	14px, lh 1.5, weight regular, text-secondary
type-caption	Metadata (dates, stops count, status)	12–13px, lh 1.4, weight regular, text-secondary
type-button	Button text	14–16px, lh 1.2, weight medium, text-inverse or text-strong

3. Component standard

3.1 Global component rules

- Components must use **semantic tokens only** (`color-bg-page` , `color-text-primary` , `color-action-primary` , etc.); no hard-coded hex values inside component definitions.
- Each interactive component must define a full state matrix: `default / hover / active / disabled / focus` and show it in documentation.
- Visual state changes should primarily use **contrast and lightness** shifts rather than introducing many new hues.
- Focus states must be clearly visible (e.g., a consistent focus ring token based on `color-text-strong`).

3.2 Key base components

3.2.1 Button (Primary / Secondary / Ghost)

- **Purpose:** Trigger main actions (add to route, create route, share).
- **Variants:** Primary, Secondary, Ghost.
- **Anatomy:** container, label, optional leading/trailing icon.
- **Color tokens:**
 - Primary: `background = color-action-primary` , `text = color-action-primary-text` .
 - Disabled: `background = color-surface-default` , `text = color-text-`

- **States**:
 - Hover: use `color-action-primary-hover`.
 - Active: slightly darker than primary.
 - Focus: add a visible outline using `color-text-strong`.

3.2.2 Tag / Chip

- **Purpose**: Artwork tags (Spain / Modern / Oil...), filters, route status labels.
- **Variants**: default, selected, disabled.
- **Color tokens**:
 - Default: `bg = color-surface-default`, `text = color-text-secondary`.
 - Selected: `bg = color-surface-soft-cool` or `color-surface-soft-warm`, `text = color-text-strong`.

3.2.3 Card

- **Purpose**: Route cards, footprint cards, artwork list items.
- **Anatomy**: container, title area, meta area (date, stops, status), optional actions (Share).
- **Color tokens**:
 - Standard card: `bg = color-surface-default`, `title = color-text-primary`, `meta = color-text-secondary`.
 - Footprint card: `bg = color-footprint-bg`, `title = color-footprint-highlight` or `color-text-primary`.
- **Interaction**: hover adds `shadow-soft` and optional border emphasis.

3.2.4 Overlay / Modal

- **Purpose**: Artwork details, “Share your visit” dialog.
- **Layout**: centered fixed-width container over a semi-transparent scrim.
- **Color tokens**:
 - Scrim: black with ~40–60% opacity.
 - Container: `bg = color-surface-default`, `title/body = color-text-primary`, secondary info `color-text-secondary`.

3.1.5 Stepper / Route Wizard

- **Purpose:** Multi-step route creation (fill details → select artworks → review & confirm).
- **Anatomy:** step indicators, connecting lines, content area, Prev/Next buttons.
- **Color tokens:**
 - Current step: `color-action-primary`.
 - Completed steps: `color-text-secondary` / muted accent.

3.2.6 Map Panel (City map & floor plan)

- **Purpose:** Show between-museum routes on a city map and in-museum floor plans.
- **Anatomy:** base map, route paths, markers, side list.
- **Color tokens:**
 - Route line and active markers: `color-footprint-highlight`.
 - Background: `color-footprint-bg` (for Footprint view) or neutral background for planning view.

4. Page patterns

Page patterns describe **how components are composed** into layout templates for key flows.

4.1 Discovery – List + overlay

- **Layout:**
 - Top: search bar + filter area (optional soft cool background).
 - Middle: artwork cards grid/list (`color-surface-default`).
 - Interaction: clicking a card opens an **Artwork Detail Overlay** instead of a full page navigation.
- **Key components:** Search, Filter chips, Artwork card, Artwork detail overlay, “Add to route planner” button.

4.2 Route Planner – Sidebar + content + map / floor plan

- **Layout:**

- Left: routes list (cards).
- Center: current route's stops list (museum segments, artworks).
- Right: city map or floor plan (Map Panel).
- **Color usage:**
 - Page `bg = color-bg-page`, cards `bg = color-surface-default`.
 - Selected museum / artwork may use `color-surface-soft-cool` or `color-surface-soft-warm` as highlight.

4.3 Footprint – Completed routes + world map + sharing

- **Layout:**
 - Left: completed routes list with Share actions (cards).
 - Right: world map Footmap (`bg = color-footprint-bg`, routes = `color-footprint-highlight`).
- **Share flow:**
 - “Share” opens a modal showing a visual card (route illustration) plus a text block; primary CTA button uses `color-action-primary`.
- **Visual intent:**
 - Reserve `color-footprint-bg` and `color-share-highlight` mostly for this area to make Footprint feel like a distinct “personal archive”.

Appendix

[Accessibility Check Result](#)

Color palettes selections:

